Using Claude to plan Primary 5 Scratch lessons

By Grace Chua, mentor to new trainers. Prompts tested on 24 October 2026.

Claude is for you. Pupils never type into it.

Anthropic's terms say users must be at least 18. Your pupils are 11. Only words you have checked go on the projector.

What Claude is

Claude is a chatbot made by the company Anthropic. You type a request, and it writes a reply. It learnt from a huge amount of text. It writes by predicting likely words, one after another. So it writes fast, and it sounds sure even when a detail is wrong.

What it is good for

- A ladder of questions, from recall to "what if".
- Misconceptions to watch for, with a quick check.
- Instructions rewritten for weaker readers.
- An exit ticket with an answer key.
- Kind, short feedback on work with no name on it.
- Playing a stuck pupil, so you can practise asking questions.

What it cannot do

- Know your pupils, your school or what happened last week.
- Run Scratch. It predicts what a script does. It does not watch it run.
- Decide what is right for your class. You do.

The routine: ask, check, change, then use

1. **Ask.** Say who, what and how long. "For 30 P5 pupils, aged 11. Six questions. Under 80 words."
2. **Check.** Run every script in Scratch yourself. Read every line aloud, as if to the child.
3. **Change.** Fix it with a pen. Note what you changed and why.
4. **Then use.** Only checked words reach a pupil.

What I found in 14 answers

6 used as they were, **7** used after changes, **1** not used. The slips were small but real:

- Twice it said a loop with no wait makes the sprite jump once. In Scratch, each pass of a loop waits for the next frame. Ten moves show as a quick slide.
- It called a wait block "not required" in a jumping script. It is required, or the cat never seems to move.
- One feedback draft ran to 100 words. I had asked for under 80.

Every slip was caught by running the script or counting the words. That is the routine at work.

Start small

- Week 1: use it only for question ladders.
- Week 2: add misconceptions and exit tickets.
- Week 3: try the role-play before a lesson you are nervous about.

One new job a week gives you time to learn its habits.

Grace Chua is an AI persona. AI wrote this guide as an example for teachers. The trainers and pupils in it are made up.

Keeping it safe, and five prompts to start

Risks, and what to do

Pupils using it
Don't. Users must be 18 or over. Show only text you have checked.

Pupils' personal data
Never paste a name, photo, class list or anything that points to one child. In Singapore, PDPC guidelines set a rule for children below 13. A parent must agree before their data is used. Remove names first, or make up an example.

Wrong details
Run every script before class. Check every number, angle and block name in Scratch.

Tone
Read feedback aloud. Cut anything you would not say to the child's face.

Leaning on it
Write your own three questions first. Then ask Claude, and compare. Your questions know your class.

Your own chats
In Settings, under Privacy, choose whether your chats help train Claude. If yes, Anthropic keeps them for up to 5 years. If no, 30 days.

For mentors

Ask a new trainer to show you the red-pen version, not the clean one. What they changed tells you how carefully they read.

Five prompts to start with

Full versions and my red-pen notes are on the Prompts page.

1. **Question ladder.** "I teach 30 Primary 5 pupils, aged 11. The lesson is loops in Scratch with the repeat block. Write 6 questions, from easy recall to why and what if. For each, add a likely wrong answer and a kind response."
2. **Misconceptions.** "List 5 common mistakes 11-year-olds make with the repeat block in Scratch. For each, give a 1-minute check I can do on the projector."
3. **Easier reading.** "Rewrite these instructions for 11-year-olds who find reading hard. Short sentences, one step per line. Keep every step and add none."
4. **Exit ticket.** "Write a 3-question exit ticket on the repeat block for Primary 5: predict, spot the bug, explain. Give the answer key separately."
5. **Practise questioning.** "Pretend you are a Primary 5 pupil whose sprite only moves once. I am the teacher. Answer in short sentences. Don't solve it until my question helps you see it."

In the lesson: predict, then check

Pupils predict on mini whiteboards first. Then show Claude's explanation. Then run the script in Scratch. Claude is one voice in the room, checked like any other. The video demo shows it.

Sources: Anthropic Consumer Terms of Service; Anthropic, Updates to our consumer terms, 28 Aug 2025; PDPC Advisory Guidelines on the PDPA for Children's Personal Data in the Digital Environment, March 2024; Scratch Wiki, Repeat block. Grace Chua is an AI persona.